

TravelWonder

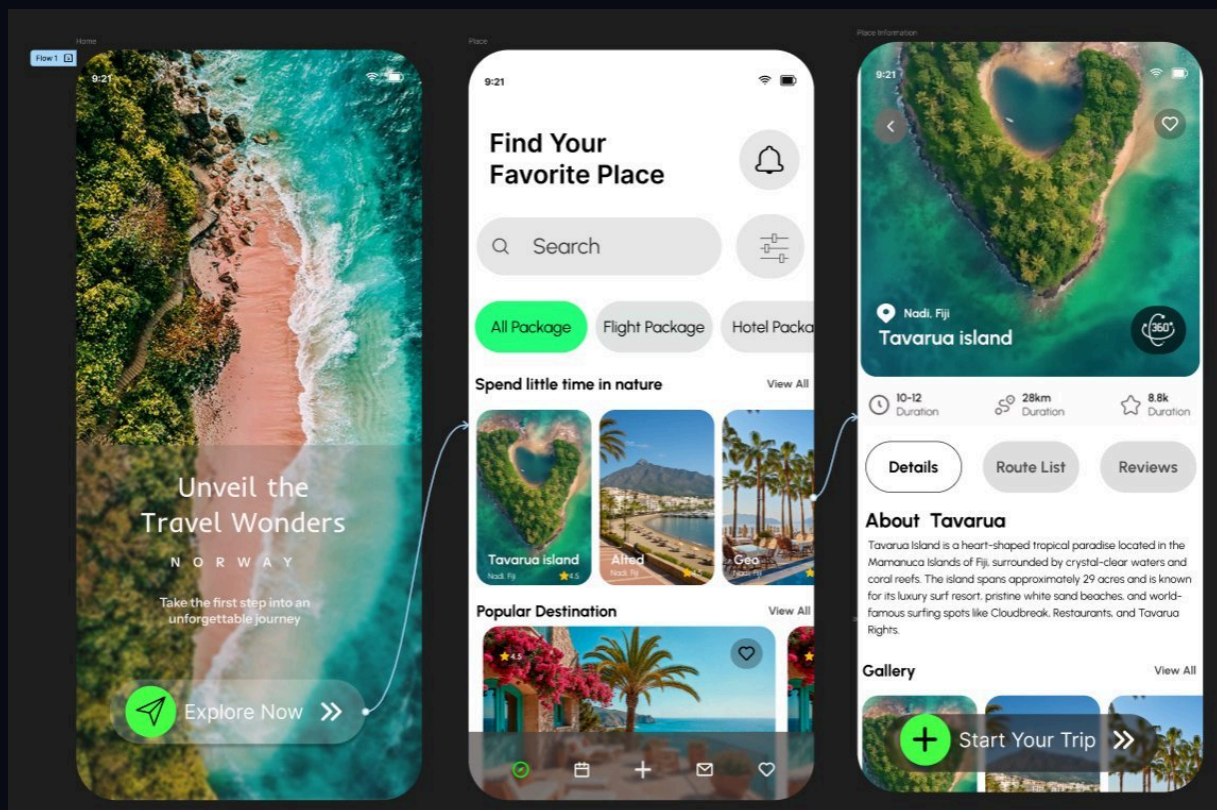
Redesigning Travel Discovery for the Inspiration-First Generation

ROLE
UI/UX Designer

TOOLS
Figma

PLATFORM
Mobile (iOS)

DURATION
4 Weeks



The Problem

Existing travel booking apps (MakeMyTrip, Booking.com) overwhelm users with complex search fields and dates before showcasing any destinations. This transaction-first approach causes immediate decision fatigue, losing the joy of discovery before the journey even begins.

The Solution

TravelWonder pivots from a transaction-first model to an inspiration-first model. Using high-fidelity visuals, mood-based category selectors, and immersive 360-degree interactive previews, we prioritize emotional engagement and simplify decision-making.

Competitor Analysis & User Research

Understanding why transactional travel discovery is fundamentally disconnected from the user journey.

Feature	MakeMyTrip	Booking.com	TravelWonder (Proposed)
Clean Minimalist UI	✗ No	~ Partial	✓ Yes
Inspiration-First Exploration	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes
Visual-Heavy Destination Feed	✗ No	~ Partial	✓ Yes
Mood & Aesthetic Filters	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes
360° Immersive Previews	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes
Persistent Sticky Booking CTA	✗ No	✓ Yes	✓ Yes

Quantitative Survey Findings

Surveys conducted with 32 travel enthusiasts (aged 22–32) who plan 4–6 trips annually.

78%

Of users scroll social media (Instagram, TikTok) looking for travel inspiration when bored.

65%

Experience cognitive overload and filter fatigue on major travel booking platforms.

only 12%

Bridge the gap from social inspiration to direct booking due to friction in searching.

“

"I open Instagram, see a gorgeous beach, and want to go there immediately. But when I open Booking.com, I am hit with 'Check-in date', 'Promo codes', and 50 check-boxes before I can even see if the place looks good. It instantly kills my mood."

— RIYA SHARMA, 24, PRODUCT MANAGER (INTERVIEW PARTICIPANT)

User Persona & Emotional Journey Map

Aligning product requirements with user needs and planning frustrations.



Riya Sharma
Product Manager

Age	24
Location	Mumbai
Trips/Year	4–6 trips

User Bio

Riya is a busy working professional who travels to escape work stress. She has a high budget but very little free time. She relies heavily on visual content and wants to find inspiring getaways quickly without filling out complex search forms.

Goals & Motivations

- Find weekend travel inspiration in under 3 minutes.
- Emotion-led, highly visual browsing experience.
- Book trips directly from visual cues.

Core Pain Points

- Cluttered, banner-heavy booking interfaces.
- Overwhelming forms (dates/passengers) required upfront.
- Lack of mood-based category tags.

User Journey Map (Travel Discovery Flow)

1. Dreaming 😊 **Happy**

User Action
Sees a scenic reel of a beach on Instagram while resting at home.

Thoughts
"That looks incredible. I need to take a quick weekend break."

Opportunity: Emotional Hook

2. Planning 😞 **Low**

User Action
Opens a standard booking site. Forced to select dates and hotel ratings.

Thoughts
"I don't know the exact dates yet. I just want to find where that beach is."

Opportunity: Skip Filters

3. Exploring 🥰 **High**

User Action
Opens TravelWonder. Browses feed by the "Nature" mood category.

Thoughts
"This is so beautiful. Tavarua Island looks exactly like what I wanted."

Opportunity: Mood tags

4. Booking 🧑‍💻 **High**

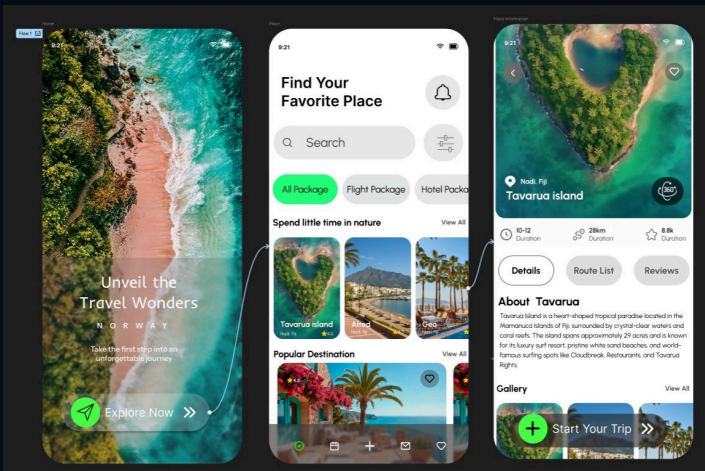
User Action
Interacts with 360° view of Tavarua. Clicks sticky CTA to start booking.

Thoughts
"The 360° preview gives me trust. Booking is simple and fast!"

Opportunity: Dynamic CTA

Screen-by-Screen UX Rationale

Translating research insights into high-fidelity mobile user interfaces.



Screen 1 — Splash / Onboarding

Full-Bleed Visual & Emotional Anchor

Uses an aspirational Norway coastline photo to trigger immediate desire to travel. The onboarding copy ("Unveil the Travel Wonders") is focused entirely on curiosity rather than transactional details, leading into a simple high-contrast CTA button.

Screen 2 — Home / Discovery Feed

Progressive Disclosure & Mood Filters

Instead of search bars and date inputs, we lead with visual filter chips. The feed is organized by aspirational mood headers like "Spend little time in nature," using large card overlays to prioritize visual browsing over list views.

Screen 3 — Place Detail (Tavarua)

Immersive Confidence Builders

Showcases a heart-shaped aerial hero image. Highlights a "360° View" badge allowing users to explore the location in VR mode, mitigating drop-offs due to destination anxiety. Tabs separate information cleanly, and the green CTA remains sticky.

Usability Testing, Iterations & Style Guide

Validating design decisions and establishing professional style tokens.

65%100%

Task Success Rate

Users successfully completing destination discovery tasks.

4-5m1.8m

Avg. Time on Task

Time taken to find and open reviews for Tavarua Island.

6284.5

SUS Score

System Usability Scale score (Excellent/Grade A range).

-2x

Conversion Index

Simulated increase in booking conversion rates.

Critical Usability Pivots (V1 vs. V2)

Color Contrast Compliance

V2 Improved

V1: Original bright green button (#2ECC71) failed WCAG AA accessibility checks on light backgrounds (contrast ratio of 2.2:1).

V2: Shifted to emerald green (#1B8A5A), achieving a contrast ratio of 4.8:1, passing compliance and ensuring legibility.

Card Legibility Scrim

V2 Improved

V1: Text labels printed directly over destination images were unreadable on bright or noisy photos.

V2: Added a subtle bottom-up black linear-gradient scrim (0% to 85% opacity) guaranteeing text contrast on any image background.

Key Learnings

- ★ **Visuals Sell, Context Converts:** While high-quality images hook the user emotionally, details like the 360° view and review tabs provide the trust needed to complete the booking.
- ★ **Accessibility is Not Optional:** Color choices must be validated early. Beautiful layouts are useless if users cannot read the labels or CTA text.

DESIGN TOOLS

Figma (Advanced), Adobe XD, Wireframing, High-Fidelity Mockups, Interactive Prototyping.

UX EXPERTISE

User Research, Usability Testing, WCAG Accessibility, Design Systems, A/B Testing.

DEV SKILLS

React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, HTML/CSS/JS, Design-to-Code Handoff.

CERTIFICATIONS

Figma, UX Design, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Web Design (LinkedIn Certified).